

IoT-Enabled Aquaculture System with Feeding, Mortality Detection, Budgeting, Monitoring, and Alerts

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April 2026

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Dissertation submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the Bachelor of
Science (Hons) in Information Technology, Specializing in Information Technology

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DECLARATION

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1 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

Aquaculture has emerged as one of the fastest-growing sectors in global food production, playing a vital role in addressing the increasing demand for protein-rich food. With the global population expanding rapidly, the pressure on traditional fisheries has intensified, leading to the adoption of controlled fish farming practices. Aquaculture systems enable the cultivation of fish in managed environments, improving production efficiency and sustainability.

However, maintaining optimal conditions within aquaculture systems remains a significant challenge. Fish are highly sensitive to environmental variations, including temperature fluctuations, oxygen levels, and water quality changes. Even minor deviations from ideal conditions can lead to stress, disease outbreaks, or mortality. Among these issues, fish mortality is one of the most critical concerns, as it directly affects productivity, economic returns, and system stability.

Traditionally, fish farmers rely on manual observation to monitor fish behavior and environmental conditions. This involves periodically checking fish movement, feeding patterns, and visible signs of distress. While this method is simple, it is inefficient and unreliable. Human observation is limited by time, attention, and environmental visibility, making it difficult to detect early signs of abnormal behavior.

In recent years, technological advancements have introduced new approaches to aquaculture monitoring. The **Internet of Things (IoT)** enables continuous data collection through sensors, allowing real-time monitoring of environmental parameters. At the same time, **computer vision technologies** have made it possible to analyze visual data from cameras to monitor fish behavior automatically. These developments have paved the way for intelligent aquaculture systems that can operate with minimal human intervention [1].

The integration of IoT and computer vision offers a powerful solution for improving fish monitoring systems. By combining sensor data with visual analysis, it is possible to create systems capable of detecting abnormalities early and providing timely alerts. Such systems can significantly reduce manual effort and improve the accuracy of monitoring processes.

1.2 Problem Statement

Despite the advancements in aquaculture technologies, early detection of fish mortality remains a challenging problem. Existing monitoring systems often focus on environmental parameters such as temperature, pH, and dissolved oxygen levels. While these factors are important, they do not always provide immediate indications of fish health conditions.

Manual monitoring methods present several limitations. They do not provide continuous observation and are subject to human error. Farmers may not notice subtle behavioral changes, such as reduced movement or abnormal swimming patterns, which often occur before fish mortality. As a result, fish deaths are typically detected only after significant losses have occurred.

In addition, some modern systems utilize image-based detection techniques to classify fish conditions. However, many of these approaches rely on analyzing individual frames independently. This method is insufficient for accurate mortality detection because it ignores temporal behavior. A fish that appears motionless in a single frame may still be alive, leading to false detections.

Another limitation is the lack of integration between environmental events and fish behavior monitoring. Environmental changes, such as rainfall, can significantly affect water conditions. However, many systems do not incorporate these external factors into their detection mechanisms.

Furthermore, cloud-based systems introduce latency and require stable internet connectivity, which may not always be available in aquaculture environments. This limits the practicality of such systems for real-time monitoring.

Therefore, there is a need for a system that can:

- Monitor fish continuously in real time
- Analyze behavior over time rather than relying on single images
- Integrate environmental sensing for better context awareness
- Operate with low latency using edge computing
- Provide timely alerts for abnormal conditions

1.3 Research Gap

Although existing systems have made progress in aquaculture monitoring, several limitations remain. Many systems operate independently, focusing either on environmental sensing or image-based detection. This lack of integration results in incomplete analysis.

A major limitation of current vision-based systems is the reliance on single-frame classification. These systems do not consider temporal behavior, leading to inaccurate results. Fish mortality is typically associated with sustained abnormal behavior rather than a single observation.

Additionally, there is limited use of behavior-based detection methods that analyze movement patterns over time. Such methods are essential for improving detection accuracy.

Another gap is the absence of event-driven environmental monitoring. External factors such as rainfall can influence fish behavior and water conditions, yet they are often ignored in detection systems.

This research addresses these gaps by developing a system that integrates:

- Real-time video monitoring
- Behavior-based analysis
- Environmental event detection
- Edge-based processing

1.4 Research Objectives

1.4.1 General Objective

The primary objective of this research is to design and implement a **real-time fish mortality detection system** using computer vision and IoT technologies.

1.4.2 Specific Objectives

The specific objectives of this study include:

- To develop a **continuous monitoring system** using a Raspberry Pi camera
- To implement **fish detection using deep learning models**
- To analyze **fish movement patterns over time**
- To detect abnormal behaviors such as prolonged inactivity and floating
- To integrate **environmental event detection**, particularly rainfall
- To design an **alert system** for notifying users
- To deploy the system using **edge computing and cloud integration**

1.5 Scope of the Study

This research focuses on the development of a **fish mortality detection module** within a smart aquaculture system. The system is designed to monitor fish behavior using live video captured from a camera.

The scope includes:

- Real-time video capture using a Raspberry Pi camera
- Processing video frames using computer vision techniques
- Detecting fish and analyzing their movement
- Identifying abnormal behavior patterns
- Integrating environmental sensing such as rain detection
- Generating alerts through a web-based dashboard

The system is implemented using an **edge computing approach**, where processing is performed locally on the Raspberry Pi. This reduces latency and minimizes dependency on network connectivity.

The study does not cover other modules such as automated feeding systems or financial management, as they are outside the scope of this research.

1.6 Significance of the Study

This research provides several important contributions to aquaculture monitoring:

Improved Fish Survival

Early detection of abnormal behavior allows timely intervention, reducing fish mortality rates.

Automation of Monitoring

The system reduces the need for manual observation, improving efficiency and consistency.

Real-Time Alerts

Immediate notification of critical events enables quick response and minimizes losses.

Integration of Technologies

Combining IoT and computer vision creates a more intelligent and effective monitoring system.

Scalability

The system can be expanded for use in larger aquaculture environments.

1.7 Methodology Overview

The proposed system follows a layered architecture.

- **Data Acquisition Layer:** Captures video and environmental data
- **Processing Layer:** Uses OpenCV and deep learning for analysis
- **Communication Layer:** Transfers data using IoT protocols
- **Application Layer:** Displays results on a dashboard

The system continuously captures video, processes frames, and analyzes fish behavior to detect abnormalities.

1.8 Organization of the Thesis

This thesis is organized into several chapters:

- Chapter 1 introduces the research background and objectives
- Chapter 2 reviews related work
- Chapter 3 explains the methodology
- Chapter 4 describes implementation
- Chapter 5 presents results and discussion
- Chapter 6 concludes the study
- Chapter 7 discusses future work
- Chapter 8 explores commercialization aspects

2 LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction

The integration of advanced technologies into aquaculture has significantly improved the efficiency and sustainability of fish farming systems. Traditional monitoring approaches, which rely on manual observation, are increasingly being replaced by automated systems that utilize IoT, computer vision, and machine learning techniques. These technologies enable continuous monitoring, real-time analysis, and early detection of abnormal conditions.

This chapter critically reviews existing research related to IoT-based aquaculture monitoring, computer vision techniques for fish detection, behavior-based mortality analysis, and supporting technologies such as edge computing and real-time communication systems. The discussion not only summarizes existing work but also evaluates their limitations and identifies gaps that motivate the proposed system.

2.2 IoT-Based Aquaculture Monitoring Systems

IoT has been widely adopted in aquaculture for monitoring environmental parameters such as temperature, pH, dissolved oxygen, and turbidity. These systems typically consist of sensor nodes connected to a central server, enabling continuous data collection and remote monitoring.

Lee et al. [1] proposed an IoT-based aquaculture monitoring system that collects real-time environmental data and provides remote access to farmers. The study demonstrated improved operational efficiency; however, it primarily focused on environmental parameters and did not include direct monitoring of fish behavior. Similarly, Zhang et al. [2] developed a wireless sensor network to monitor water quality. While their system effectively captured environmental changes, it lacked mechanisms to detect fish health conditions directly.

A key limitation of these IoT-based systems is their **indirect approach to fish health monitoring**. Environmental data alone cannot reliably indicate fish mortality, as fish behavior often provides earlier and more accurate indicators of stress or death. This highlights the need for integrating visual monitoring techniques with IoT systems.

2.3 Computer Vision in Fish Monitoring

Computer vision has emerged as a powerful tool for analyzing fish behavior in aquaculture environments. Early approaches relied on traditional image processing techniques such as background subtraction, edge detection, and segmentation.

Li et al. [3] introduced a vision-based system that detects fish using image segmentation. Although the system was effective under controlled conditions, its performance was significantly affected by water turbidity and lighting variations. Qin et al. [4] proposed a tracking system that monitors fish movement patterns. While this approach provided insights into behavior, it required high computational resources and was not suitable for real-time deployment on low-power devices.

With the advancement of deep learning, computer vision systems have become more robust and accurate. However, many studies still focus primarily on **detection and tracking**, rather than interpreting behavioral patterns related to mortality. This limits their practical applicability in real-world aquaculture systems.

2.4 Deep Learning Models for Fish Detection

Deep learning has significantly improved object detection accuracy, particularly with the introduction of convolutional neural networks (CNNs). Among these models, YOLO has gained popularity due to its real-time performance.

Redmon et al. [5] introduced the YOLO framework, which performs object detection in a single pass, enabling high-speed processing. Later improvements in YOLOv5 and YOLOv8 further enhanced detection accuracy and efficiency [6]. Chen et al. [7] applied YOLO-based models for fish detection and achieved high accuracy in identifying fish in complex environments.

Despite these advancements, most deep learning applications in aquaculture focus on **object detection rather than behavior analysis**. Detecting the presence of fish does not necessarily provide information about their health condition. Therefore, additional mechanisms are required to interpret behavioral patterns over time.

2.5 Behaviour Based Fish Mortality Detection

Fish behavior is a critical indicator of their health. Abnormal behaviors such as reduced movement, floating, or erratic swimming patterns often precede mortality.

Spampinato et al. [8] conducted a study on fish behavior analysis using video data and found that motion patterns can be used to predict fish health conditions. Zhao et al. [9] further demonstrated that prolonged inactivity is a reliable indicator of fish mortality.

Compared to image-based classification, behavior-based analysis provides a more accurate approach to mortality detection. However, implementing such systems in real time is challenging due to the need for continuous tracking and temporal analysis. Many existing systems do not fully utilize behavioral information, limiting their effectiveness.

2.6 Edge Computing in Real-Time Monitoring

Edge computing has become increasingly important in IoT applications, particularly for real-time systems. Instead of sending data to the cloud for processing, edge devices perform computations locally, reducing latency and bandwidth usage.

Shi et al. [10] highlighted the advantages of edge computing in real-time applications, including improved responsiveness and reduced dependency on network connectivity. Raspberry Pi devices are commonly used as edge processors due to their affordability and flexibility.

In aquaculture systems, edge computing enables real-time video analysis and immediate detection of abnormal conditions. However, the limited computational power of edge devices

requires efficient algorithms and optimized models.

2.7 Real-Time Video Streaming Technologies

Real-time video streaming is essential for remote monitoring systems. Technologies such as RTSP, HLS, and WebRTC are widely used for transmitting video data.

MediaMTX is a lightweight streaming server that supports multiple protocols and enables low-latency video delivery [11]. It allows video streams to be accessed through web dashboards, making it suitable for real-time monitoring applications.

While streaming technologies provide visual access, they are often not integrated with intelligent analysis systems. This separation limits the effectiveness of monitoring solutions.

2.8 IoT Communication Using MQTT

MQTT is a lightweight messaging protocol designed for IoT applications. It follows a publish–subscribe model, enabling efficient communication between devices.

Banks and Gupta [12] described MQTT as a reliable protocol for real-time data transmission with minimal bandwidth usage. EMQX is a scalable MQTT broker that supports high-throughput communication.

In aquaculture systems, MQTT is used to transmit sensor data and system events. However, many implementations focus only on data transmission without integrating intelligent analysis.

2.9 Cloud-Based Backend Systems

Cloud computing plays a crucial role in managing data in IoT systems. Platforms such as Supabase provide database services, authentication, and real-time updates.

Pahl [13] discussed the benefits of cloud-based architectures, including scalability and flexibility. Cloud systems enable remote access to data and support large-scale deployments. However, reliance on cloud processing introduces latency and requires stable internet connectivity. This limitation can be addressed by combining cloud services with edge computing.

2.10 Integration Challenges in Existing Systems

A major challenge in aquaculture monitoring systems is the lack of integration between different technologies. Many systems operate in isolation, focusing on either environmental monitoring or visual analysis.

For example, IoT systems provide environmental data but lack direct observation of fish

behavior, while computer vision systems detect fish but do not consider environmental factors. This separation results in incomplete analysis and reduces system effectiveness. An integrated approach that combines IoT, computer vision, and edge computing is necessary to address these challenges.

2.11 Research Gap

Based on the analysis of existing studies, several key research gaps have been identified. First, there is a lack of systems that integrate **real-time computer vision with IoT-based environmental monitoring**. Most systems focus on either visual detection or sensor data, but not both.

Second, many vision-based systems rely on **single-frame analysis**, which does not capture temporal behavior. This leads to inaccurate detection of fish mortality.

Third, there is limited use of **behavior-based detection methods**, which are essential for identifying abnormal conditions over time.

Fourth, existing systems rarely incorporate **event-driven environmental monitoring**, such as detecting rainfall and its impact on fish behavior.

Finally, many solutions depend heavily on cloud-based processing, resulting in increased latency and reduced reliability in remote environments.

The proposed system addresses these gaps by integrating:

- Real-time video monitoring
- Behavior-based analysis
- Environmental event detection
- Edge-based processing

2.12 Summary

This chapter reviewed existing research on IoT-based aquaculture systems, computer vision techniques, and fish behavior analysis. While significant progress has been made, current systems lack comprehensive solutions for real-time fish mortality detection.

The analysis highlights the need for an integrated system that combines multiple technologies to improve accuracy and efficiency. The proposed system builds upon these insights to develop a robust solution for real-time fish monitoring and mortality detection.

3 METHODOLOGY

3.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the methodology adopted for the design and implementation of the fish mortality detection system. The system integrates computer vision techniques, Internet of Things (IoT) communication, and cloud-based services to enable real-time monitoring of fish behavior and environmental conditions. The primary focus of this methodology is to accurately detect fish mortality by analyzing behavioral patterns over time rather than relying solely on static image classification.

The proposed system follows a hybrid architecture that combines edge computing and cloud services. The Raspberry Pi device acts as the edge processor, performing real-time video acquisition and initial processing, while cloud-based components handle data storage, streaming, and user interaction. This approach ensures low latency, efficient resource utilization, and continuous monitoring.

3.2 System Architecture

The system architecture is designed to support real-time monitoring, efficient data processing, and reliable communication between components. It consists of multiple interconnected layers, including the edge layer, streaming layer, backend layer, communication layer, and application layer.

At the edge layer, the Raspberry Pi captures video from the camera and performs initial processing. The processed data is then transmitted to the streaming layer, where a media server handles video distribution. The backend layer manages system logic, data storage, and alert generation, while the communication layer enables real-time data exchange using IoT protocols. Finally, the application layer provides a user interface for monitoring and interaction.

This layered architecture ensures modularity, scalability, and efficient operation of the system.

3.3 Hardware Design

The hardware configuration of the system is centered around the Raspberry Pi, which serves as the main processing unit. The Raspberry Pi is selected due to its low cost, compact size, and ability to support both hardware interfacing and software processing.

A camera module is connected to the Raspberry Pi to capture continuous video of the fish pond. The camera is positioned strategically to ensure maximum visibility of fish movement. Proper placement of the camera is critical, as it directly affects the accuracy of detection and behavior analysis.

The system may also include environmental sensors such as rain sensors to detect external

conditions that may influence fish health. These sensors provide additional context for interpreting fish behavior.

3.4 Video Acquisition and Preprocessing

The system continuously captures video frames using the camera module connected to the Raspberry Pi. The captured video stream is processed frame by frame using the OpenCV library. Each frame undergoes preprocessing steps to improve the quality of analysis.

Preprocessing includes resizing the frame to match the input size required by the detection model, reducing noise, and adjusting brightness and contrast if necessary. These steps ensure that the input data is suitable for accurate detection.

The processed frames are then forwarded to the detection module for further analysis.

3.5 Fish Detection Model

The system utilizes a deep learning model based on the YOLO (You Only Look Once) architecture for detecting fish in video frames. YOLO is chosen due to its ability to perform real-time object detection with high accuracy and efficiency.

The model is trained using a dataset consisting of approximately 5,000 images, which include various fish conditions. The dataset is divided into training, validation, and testing sets to ensure proper model evaluation.

During operation, the model processes each frame and identifies fish by generating bounding boxes along with confidence scores. Only detections with confidence above a predefined threshold are considered valid. This helps reduce false detections and improves overall accuracy.

3.6 Behavior-Based Mortality Detection

Unlike traditional systems that rely solely on image classification, the proposed system uses a behavior-based approach to detect fish mortality. This approach considers the movement patterns of fish over time, providing a more reliable method for identifying abnormal conditions.

The system tracks detected fish across consecutive frames and calculates a movement score based on their displacement. If a fish remains motionless for a prolonged period, it is considered a potential indicator of mortality. In addition, the system monitors the orientation of the fish. If a fish is observed to be floating near the surface or exhibiting abnormal posture, it is flagged as a high-risk condition.

To improve reliability, the system does not trigger alerts based on a single condition. Instead,

multiple indicators are evaluated together. A mortality alert is generated only when consistent abnormal behavior is observed over a defined time window. This reduces false positives and ensures more accurate detection.

3.7 Edge Processing Strategy

The system performs all critical processing tasks locally on the Raspberry Pi. This edge computing approach eliminates the need to send raw video data to the cloud for processing, thereby reducing latency and bandwidth usage.

By performing detection and behavior analysis at the edge, the system can respond to abnormal conditions in real time. This is particularly important in aquaculture environments where timely intervention is crucial.

The model and processing algorithms are optimized to run efficiently on the Raspberry Pi, ensuring smooth operation despite limited computational resources.

3.8 Video Streaming Mechanism

The system implements a real-time video streaming pipeline to allow users to monitor the fish pond remotely. The Raspberry Pi sends the video stream to a media server using the RTMP protocol. The media server, implemented using MediaMTX, converts the incoming stream into a format suitable for web-based playback, such as HLS.

The frontend dashboard retrieves the video stream and displays it to the user. This enables continuous monitoring of the pond in real time.

The streaming mechanism is designed to balance performance and quality, ensuring low latency while maintaining acceptable video clarity.

3.9 Environmental Event Detection

In addition to visual monitoring, the system incorporates environmental event detection to provide context-aware analysis. A rain sensor is used to detect rainfall events, which can significantly impact water conditions.

When rainfall is detected, the system triggers additional monitoring processes. This event-driven approach ensures that environmental factors are considered in the detection process, improving the overall accuracy of the system.

3.10 IoT Communication Using MQTT

The system uses the MQTT protocol to facilitate communication between different components. MQTT follows a publish-subscribe model, which allows devices to send and

receive data efficiently.

The Raspberry Pi and sensors publish data to specific topics, while the backend subscribes to these topics to receive updates. This enables real-time communication and ensures that the system remains responsive.

The EMQX broker is used to manage MQTT communication, providing scalability and reliability.

3.11 Backend and Data Management

The backend system is responsible for managing data, handling requests, and generating alerts. Supabase is used as the backend platform, providing a PostgreSQL database along with real-time capabilities.

The backend stores detection results, system logs, and alert information. It also provides APIs for communication with the frontend dashboard.

This centralized data management system ensures consistency and enables efficient retrieval of information.

3.12 Alert Generation Mechanism

The system includes an automated alert generation mechanism to notify users of critical conditions. Alerts are triggered when the system detects abnormal fish behavior or environmental events.

Once an alert condition is met, the backend processes the information and sends notifications to the user interface. These alerts allow users to take immediate action, reducing the risk of further fish mortality.

3.13 Frontend Dashboard Design

The frontend dashboard serves as the user interface for the system. It provides real-time visualization of the video stream, detection results, and system status.

Users can monitor fish behavior, view alerts, and interact with the system through the dashboard. The interface is designed to be user-friendly and responsive, ensuring ease of use.

3.14 System Workflow

The overall workflow of the system begins with video capture at the Raspberry Pi. The captured frames are processed and analyzed using the detection model. Behavior analysis is then performed to identify abnormal conditions.

The results are transmitted to the backend, where alerts are generated if necessary. The

frontend dashboard displays the live video and system status, allowing users to monitor the pond in real time.

3.15 Summary

This chapter described the methodology used to develop the fish mortality detection system. The system integrates computer vision, IoT communication, and cloud services to provide a comprehensive monitoring solution. By combining behavior analysis with edge computing, the system achieves accurate and real-time detection of fish mortality.

4 IMPLEMENTATION

4.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the practical implementation of the fish mortality detection system. It explains how the system components described in the methodology are developed and integrated to achieve real-time monitoring and detection. The implementation includes the camera interface, video processing pipeline, deep learning model integration, streaming mechanism, backend services, and frontend dashboard.

The system is designed to operate as a complete pipeline, starting from video capture at the edge device and ending with real-time visualization and alert generation on the user interface.

4.2 System Development Environment

The implementation of the system is carried out using a combination of hardware and software technologies.

The edge device is built using a Raspberry Pi running a Linux-based operating system. Python is used as the primary programming language due to its compatibility with computer vision and machine learning libraries. OpenCV is used for video processing, while the deep learning model is implemented using a YOLO-based framework.

The backend services are developed using a web framework that handles API requests and system logic. The frontend dashboard is developed using React, providing a responsive user interface for monitoring.

4.3 Camera Integration and Video Capture

The camera module connected to the Raspberry Pi is responsible for capturing live video of the fish pond. The implementation uses a camera interface library to initialize and control the camera.

A dedicated service module is implemented to manage camera operations. This service

handles starting and stopping the camera, capturing frames, and providing frames for further processing. The camera continuously captures frames at a defined frame rate to ensure smooth monitoring.

Captured frames are converted into a format suitable for processing and streaming. The system ensures that the camera operates efficiently without overloading the Raspberry Pi resources.

4.4 Video Frame Processing

Once the video frames are captured, they are processed using OpenCV. Each frame is resized to match the input size required by the detection model. Preprocessing steps such as noise reduction and normalization are applied to improve detection accuracy.

The processed frames are passed to the detection module, where the deep learning model identifies fish within the frame. The system ensures that frame processing is optimized to maintain real-time performance.

4.5 Fish Detection Implementation

The fish detection functionality is implemented using a YOLO-based deep learning model. The model is loaded into the system during initialization and is used to analyze each incoming frame.

For each frame, the model detects objects and returns bounding boxes along with confidence scores. The system filters detections based on a confidence threshold to eliminate false positives.

The detected fish are highlighted on the frame using bounding boxes. These annotated frames are used both for display and further analysis.

4.6 Behavior Analysis Implementation

The system implements behavior-based logic to detect fish mortality. Instead of relying solely on detection results, it analyzes the movement of fish across multiple frames.

The position of each detected fish is tracked over time. By comparing positions across consecutive frames, the system calculates movement patterns. If a fish remains stationary for a defined duration, it is flagged as inactive.

In addition to inactivity, the system also considers orientation and position in the frame. Fish that appear near the surface or exhibit abnormal posture are identified as potential risk cases. The behavior analysis module combines multiple indicators to determine whether a fish is likely to be dead. This approach improves accuracy and reduces false detections.

4.7 Video Streaming Implementation

The system implements a real-time video streaming pipeline to allow users to monitor the pond remotely.

The Raspberry Pi sends the video stream to a media server using the RTMP protocol. The media server, implemented using MediaMTX, converts the stream into a format suitable for web-based playback, such as HLS.

The frontend dashboard retrieves the video stream using a URL provided by the server. This allows users to view the live feed directly from a web browser without requiring additional software.

The streaming system is designed to maintain low latency while ensuring stable video delivery.

4.8 Backend Implementation

The backend system is responsible for managing data and handling communication between components. It provides API endpoints for interacting with the frontend and processing system events.

The backend stores detection results, logs, and alert data in a database managed by Supabase. It also processes incoming data from the edge device and generates alerts when abnormal conditions are detected.

The backend ensures that all system components remain synchronized and that data is available for real-time monitoring.

4.9 IoT Communication Implementation

The system uses MQTT protocol for communication between devices. The Raspberry Pi and sensors publish data to MQTT topics, while the backend subscribes to these topics to receive updates.

The EMQX broker is used to manage MQTT communication. It ensures reliable message delivery and supports real-time data exchange.

This communication mechanism allows the system to respond quickly to changes and maintain continuous operation.

4.10 Alert System Implementation

The alert system is implemented to notify users of critical conditions. When the behavior analysis module detects abnormal patterns, the system generates an alert.

The backend processes the alert and sends it to the frontend dashboard. Notifications can also

be extended to external systems such as SMS services.

The alert system ensures that users are informed immediately, allowing them to take necessary actions.

4.11 Frontend Dashboard Implementation

The frontend dashboard is developed using React. It provides a user-friendly interface for monitoring the system.

The dashboard displays:

- Live video stream
- Detection results
- Alert notifications
- System status

The frontend communicates with the backend through API calls. It retrieves data and updates the interface in real time.

The design focuses on simplicity and usability, ensuring that users can easily understand the system status.

4.12 Integration of System Components

All system components are integrated to form a complete monitoring solution. The Raspberry Pi captures video and processes frames, the backend manages data and alerts, and the frontend provides visualization.

The streaming server ensures smooth video delivery, while the MQTT broker handles communication between components. This integration allows the system to operate seamlessly and provide real-time monitoring.

4.13 Challenges and Solutions

During implementation, several challenges were encountered.

One of the main challenges was ensuring real-time performance on the Raspberry Pi. This was addressed by optimizing the model and reducing processing overhead.

Another challenge was maintaining stable video streaming. This was solved by using a dedicated streaming server and optimizing network configurations.

Handling false detections was also a concern. The use of behavior-based analysis helped improve accuracy and reduce incorrect alerts.

4.14 Summary

This chapter described the implementation of the fish mortality detection system. The system integrates camera capture, deep learning-based detection, behavior analysis, streaming, and cloud services to provide real-time monitoring.

The implementation demonstrates how the proposed methodology is translated into a working system. The next chapter presents the results and evaluation of the system.

5 RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

5.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the results obtained from the implementation of the fish mortality detection system and provides a detailed discussion of its performance. The system was evaluated based on its ability to detect fish, analyze behavior, and generate alerts in real time.

The results highlight the effectiveness of combining computer vision, behavior analysis, and IoT communication for aquaculture monitoring.

5.2 Experimental Setup

The system was tested using a Raspberry Pi device connected to a camera module positioned to monitor a fish pond environment. The trained detection model was deployed on the Raspberry Pi and used to process live video streams.

The dataset used for training consisted of approximately 5,000 images, including various fish conditions such as healthy, inactive, and abnormal states. During testing, both recorded video sequences and live streaming scenarios were used to evaluate system performance. The frontend dashboard was used to monitor real-time detection results, while backend logs were used to verify alert generation and system responses.

5.3 Fish Detection Performance

The detection model demonstrated reliable performance in identifying fish in video frames under different conditions. The YOLO-based model was able to detect fish accurately in most scenarios, even with variations in lighting and water clarity.

The use of a confidence threshold helped reduce false detections. Frames with clear visibility produced higher detection accuracy, while slightly reduced performance was observed in cases of poor lighting or water disturbances.

Overall, the detection component provided a stable foundation for further behavior analysis.

5.4 Behavior Analysis Results

The behavior-based mortality detection approach proved to be effective in identifying abnormal fish conditions. By analyzing movement over time, the system was able to distinguish between normal inactivity and potential mortality.

Fish that remained motionless for a defined duration were correctly identified as inactive. When combined with positional and orientation analysis, the system was able to detect conditions such as floating behavior, which is commonly associated with fish death.

Compared to single-frame detection methods, this approach significantly reduced false positives. The use of temporal analysis improved the reliability of the system.

5.5 Real-Time Performance

One of the key objectives of the system was to achieve real-time monitoring. The implementation on the Raspberry Pi demonstrated that the system could process frames and perform detection with acceptable speed.

Although the Raspberry Pi has limited computational power, optimization techniques such as frame resizing and efficient model selection ensured smooth operation. The system maintained a consistent frame processing rate suitable for real-time monitoring.

The streaming pipeline also performed efficiently, allowing users to view live video with minimal delay through the dashboard.

5.6 Alert Generation Evaluation

The alert system successfully generated notifications when abnormal conditions were detected. Alerts were triggered based on behavior analysis results and were displayed on the frontend dashboard.

The system ensured that alerts were not generated for temporary inactivity, reducing unnecessary notifications. Only consistent abnormal patterns resulted in alerts, improving the relevance of notifications.

This behavior-based alert mechanism contributed to the overall effectiveness of the system.

5.7 Integration Performance

The integration of different system components, including the Raspberry Pi, streaming server, backend services, and frontend dashboard, was successfully achieved.

The communication between components was stable, and data was transmitted in real time.

The use of MQTT enabled efficient communication between devices, while the backend ensured proper data management. The streaming server provided reliable video delivery, and the frontend displayed results accurately.

The system operated as a cohesive unit, demonstrating the effectiveness of the integrated design.

5.8 Challenges and Limitations

Despite the successful implementation, several limitations were observed during testing. One limitation is the dependency on camera positioning. Poor camera angles or obstructions can affect detection accuracy. Similarly, extreme lighting conditions or water turbidity can reduce visibility, impacting performance.

Another limitation is the computational constraint of the Raspberry Pi. While the system operates in real time, more complex models may require additional optimization or hardware acceleration.

Additionally, the dataset used for training, although sufficient, can be further expanded to improve model generalization. More diverse data would enhance the system's ability to handle different environments.

5.9 Discussion

The results demonstrate that combining computer vision with behavior analysis provides a more reliable approach to fish mortality detection compared to traditional methods. The system successfully identifies abnormal conditions in real time and provides timely alerts. The use of edge computing ensures low latency and independence from network connectivity, making the system suitable for real-world aquaculture environments. The integration of IoT communication and cloud services further enhances system functionality.

However, improvements in dataset quality, model optimization, and environmental handling can further enhance system performance.

5.10 Summary

This chapter presented the results and evaluation of the fish mortality detection system. The demonstrated effective fish detection, accurate behavior analysis, and reliable alert generation. The findings confirm that the proposed approach is suitable for real-time aquaculture monitoring. The next chapter provides the conclusion of the study and summarizes the overall contributions.

6 CONCLUSION

6.1 Introduction

This chapter presents the conclusion of the research conducted on the development of an IoT-enabled fish mortality detection system. It summarizes the key outcomes of the study, evaluates the effectiveness of the proposed solution, and reflects on how the research objectives have been achieved. The chapter also highlights the overall contribution of the system to modern aquaculture practices.

6.2 Summary of the Study

This research focused on addressing the challenges associated with detecting fish mortality in aquaculture environments. Traditional monitoring methods were identified as inefficient due to their reliance on manual observation and lack of continuous monitoring capabilities.

To overcome these limitations, a system was developed that integrates computer vision, IoT communication, and edge computing. The system utilizes a Raspberry Pi equipped with a camera to capture live video of the fish pond. A deep learning model based on the YOLO architecture is used to detect fish in video frames, while behavior analysis techniques are applied to identify abnormal conditions such as prolonged inactivity and floating behavior.

The system also incorporates environmental awareness through event-based detection, such as rainfall monitoring, to provide additional context for analyzing fish conditions. A real-time streaming pipeline and web-based dashboard were implemented to allow users to monitor the system remotely.

6.3 Achievement of Objectives

The research objectives outlined in Chapter 1 have been successfully achieved.

The system was able to capture live video using a Raspberry Pi camera and process the data in real time. Fish detection was implemented using a deep learning model, which provided accurate identification of fish in various conditions. Behavior-based analysis was successfully integrated, allowing the system to detect abnormal patterns over time rather than relying on single-frame classification.

The system also demonstrated the ability to generate alerts when abnormal conditions were detected, ensuring timely notification to users. Additionally, the integration of IoT communication and cloud-based services enabled efficient data transmission and remote monitoring.

Overall, the developed system meets the requirements of a real-time fish mortality detection solution.

6.4 Key Contributions

This research makes several important contributions to the field of aquaculture monitoring. First, it introduces a **behavior-based approach** to fish mortality detection, which improves accuracy compared to traditional image-based methods. By analyzing movement patterns over time, the system provides more reliable detection of abnormal conditions.

Second, the research demonstrates the effectiveness of **edge computing** in real-time monitoring applications. By performing processing on the Raspberry Pi, the system reduces latency and minimizes dependency on network connectivity.

Third, the integration of **IoT communication and cloud services** provides a scalable and flexible architecture. The use of MQTT for communication and Supabase for backend management ensures efficient data handling and real-time updates.

Finally, the system provides a **practical and cost-effective solution** for aquaculture monitoring, making it suitable for real-world deployment.

6.5 System Effectiveness

The results obtained from the implementation demonstrate that the system is capable of performing real-time monitoring and detection with satisfactory accuracy. The fish detection model performed reliably under different conditions, and the behavior analysis approach reduced false positives.

The streaming system allowed users to monitor the pond remotely, while the alert mechanism ensured timely notification of critical events. The integration of all system components resulted in a stable and functional monitoring system.

Although certain limitations were identified, such as dependency on camera conditions and computational constraints, the overall system performance was effective and met the intended objectives.

6.6 Limitations of the Study

Despite the successful implementation, several limitations were observed.

The accuracy of the system is influenced by camera positioning and environmental conditions such as lighting and water clarity. Poor visibility can affect detection performance.

The computational limitations of the Raspberry Pi restrict the use of more complex models, which could potentially improve accuracy. Additionally, the dataset used for training can be further expanded to improve model generalization.

These limitations provide opportunities for future improvements.

6.7 Final Remarks

In conclusion, this research demonstrates that the integration of computer vision, IoT technologies, and edge computing can significantly improve fish mortality detection in aquaculture systems. The proposed system provides a reliable and efficient solution for real-time monitoring, reducing the need for manual observation and enabling timely intervention.

The study highlights the importance of combining multiple technologies to address complex real-world problems. With further improvements and optimization, the system has the potential to be deployed in large-scale aquaculture environments, contributing to more sustainable and efficient fish farming practices.

7 FUTURE WORK

7.1 Introduction

This chapter outlines potential improvements and future enhancements for the fish mortality detection system. While the current implementation successfully achieves real-time monitoring and detection, there are several areas where the system can be further developed to improve performance, scalability, and practical usability.

7.2 Model Improvement and Accuracy Enhancement

One of the key areas for future work is improving the accuracy of the detection model. Although the current YOLO-based model performs well, its performance can be enhanced by training with a larger and more diverse dataset. Including images captured under different lighting conditions, water turbidity levels, and fish species variations would improve the model's generalization capability.

Additionally, advanced deep learning architectures can be explored to enhance detection performance. Lightweight but more efficient models can be developed specifically optimized for edge devices such as the Raspberry Pi.

7.3 Advanced Behavior Analysis

The current system uses rule-based behavior analysis to detect abnormal fish conditions. Future improvements can include the use of machine learning techniques for temporal analysis, such as recurrent neural networks (RNNs) or temporal convolutional networks (TCNs).

These models can learn complex behavior patterns over time, enabling more accurate identification of fish stress, disease, and mortality. This would further reduce false positives and improve system reliability.

7.4 Real-Time Optimization

Although the system operates in real time, further optimization can be achieved by improving processing efficiency. Techniques such as model quantization, hardware acceleration, and parallel processing can be implemented to enhance performance.

Integration with hardware accelerators such as Google Coral or NVIDIA Jetson devices can significantly improve inference speed and enable the use of more complex models.

7.5 Enhanced Environmental Monitoring

Currently, the system incorporates basic environmental sensing, such as rain detection. Future work can include integrating additional sensors to monitor water quality parameters such as pH, dissolved oxygen, and temperature. By combining these parameters with behavior analysis, the system can provide a more comprehensive understanding of fish health and environmental conditions.

7.6 Mobile Application Integration

The current system uses a web-based dashboard for monitoring. In future, a dedicated mobile application can be developed to provide users with more convenient access to system data and

alerts.

A mobile application can offer features such as push notifications, real-time monitoring, and remote control of system settings, improving user experience.

7.7 Scalability and Multi-Pond Support

The system can be extended to support multiple ponds within a single platform. This would allow large-scale aquaculture operations to monitor multiple environments simultaneously. Cloud-based architectures can be further optimized to handle increased data volume and ensure efficient system performance at scale.

7.8 Integration with Automation Systems

Future improvements can include integrating the system with automated control mechanisms. For example, the system can automatically adjust aeration systems or trigger water quality adjustments based on detected conditions.

This would transform the system from a monitoring solution into a fully automated aquaculture management system.

7.9 Summary

This chapter discussed potential future enhancements for the system. By improving model accuracy, expanding environmental monitoring, and integrating advanced technologies, the system can be further developed into a more powerful and comprehensive aquaculture solution.

8 COMMERCIALIZATION

8.1 Introduction

This chapter explores the commercialization potential of the proposed fish mortality detection system. The system is designed as a practical and scalable solution for aquaculture monitoring, making it suitable for real-world deployment.

8.2 Market Need

Aquaculture is a rapidly growing industry, and there is a strong demand for efficient monitoring systems. Fish farmers face significant challenges in maintaining fish health and preventing losses due to mortality.

The proposed system addresses these challenges by providing real-time monitoring, automated detection, and alert mechanisms. This makes it highly valuable for commercial aquaculture operations.

8.3 Product Concept

The system can be developed into a commercial product consisting of:

- A hardware unit (Raspberry Pi with camera and sensors)
- A cloud-based platform for data management
- A web or mobile application for user interaction

This product can be offered as a complete solution for fish farmers.

8.4 Business Model

The system can be commercialized using different business models.

One approach is a **hardware plus subscription model**, where users purchase the device and pay a monthly fee for cloud services and monitoring.

Another approach is a **Software-as-a-Service (SaaS)** model, where users subscribe to the platform and integrate it with their existing systems.

These models provide flexibility and scalability for different types of users.

8.5 Cost and Benefits

The system is designed to be cost-effective, using affordable hardware components such as the Raspberry Pi. This makes it accessible to small and medium-scale fish farmers.

The benefits of the system include:

- Reduction in fish mortality
- Improved productivity
- Lower labor costs
- Better decision-making

These advantages provide strong value for users and justify the investment.

8.6 Deployment Strategy

The system can be deployed in phases, starting with pilot testing in small-scale farms.

Feedback from users can be used to improve the system before large-scale deployment.

Partnerships with aquaculture organizations and technology providers can help expand the reach of the product.

8.7 Challenges in Commercialization

Several challenges may arise during commercialization.

These include:

- Ensuring system reliability in different environments
- Managing hardware maintenance
- Providing user training and support
- Handling data security and privacy

Addressing these challenges is essential for successful deployment.

8.8 Future Market Expansion

The system can be extended to support different types of aquaculture, including shrimp farming and large-scale fish farms. Additional features such as predictive analytics and automated control can further enhance its value.

There is also potential to expand into international markets where aquaculture is a major industry.

8.9 Summary

This chapter discussed the commercialization potential of the system. The proposed solution offers significant benefits for aquaculture monitoring and has strong potential for real-world adoption.

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APPENDICES